Creating Images

Important prompts and questions from this section — copy them exactly as shown in the lectures. Replace anything in [brackets] with your own details.

Key questions from this section

- Every part of an image you don't ask for is a guess you've let the tool make. What have I left out?
- What job should this picture do? Then choose the light, angle and layout that do it.
- Does the product in the image match the real one — shape, colour, label and text?
- Does every letter in the image read correctly?
- Am I borrowing a style, or copying someone's brand?

The New Road: Your First Images in ChatGPT & Gemini

> Create an image of a stylish poster for black wireless headphones on a bright yellow background.

The Working Method: Refine by Talking

> Create an image of a cozy reading corner with a green armchair, a floor lamp and a wooden bookshelf.

> Make the lighting warmer, like early evening.

> Zoom out a little to show more of the room.

> Add a cat sleeping on the armchair.

> Remove the cat.

Will Astra Draw It Better? — The Hidden Artist

> Create an image of an astronaut relaxing in a beach chair on the moon, reading a newspaper.

Light: The Mood-Maker

> Create a product shot of an orange soda can on a plain white background.

> Light it with hard light from one side, so the shadows are sharp and dramatic.

> Change to soft window light coming from the left.

> Change to warm golden hour sunlight, like the last hour before sunset.

> Now make it dramatic: a dark background, with a cool blue rim light glowing around the edges of the can.

Camera Angle: Every Angle Has a Job

Create a product photo of a white running shoe with orange laces on a grey concrete floor, seen from eye level.

Show the same shoe from a low angle, with the camera close to the ground looking up at it.

Now show it from directly overhead, as a flat lay.

Show the same shoe from a 45-degree angle, looking down at it.

Now take a macro close-up of the laces and the stitching.

Now pull back to a wide shot: the shoe on an empty running track at sunrise.

Negative & Positive Space: The Power of Empty

Create a minimalist image of a single white paper airplane on a soft blue background. Place the plane in the lower left corner and leave the upper two-thirds empty as copy space for text.

Depth & the Lens Look: What Stays Sharp

Create a product photo of a glass perfume bottle on a marble table, shot with an 85mm lens at f/1.8, with a background of warm evening city lights turned into soft bokeh.

Now keep everything the same, but shoot it at f/16 so the background city is also sharp.

Colour: The Feeling Before the Words

Create an Instagram post for a summer linen clothing collection: a model wearing a sage green linen shirt, in an analogous colour palette of sage green, olive and soft cream.

Now create a second post for the same collection, using exactly the same colour palette: a folded stack of linen shirts on a wooden table.

Typography: Words That Get Read

Create a YouTube thumbnail for a video about growing tomatoes on a balcony. On the right, a hand holding a bright red tomato. On the left, the words "GROW THIS AT HOME" in a heavy, bold sans-serif font, white letters with a thick black outline.

Keep everything the same, but change the words to an elegant thin serif font.

Style & Finish: The Look That Ties It Together

Create an image of a small cactus in a terracotta pot as a flat vector illustration, with bold simple shapes and only three colours.

Now show the same cactus as a soft 3D clay render with a matte finish.

Now show the same cactus as a vintage 1970s film photograph with warm, faded colours and visible film grain.

Your Product: Photos & Mockups

Design the packaging for a face moisturiser called SOFT DUNE: a round frosted glass jar with a matte sand-coloured lid, and the name SOFT DUNE in a thin, elegant serif font. Minimal, calm style with a palette of sand, cream and soft white. Show it as a studio product photo on a plain cream background, with soft window light from the left, shot from a 45-degree angle, with plenty of empty space above the jar.

Now create a matching box for the same jar, in the same colours and font, and show the jar and the box standing together.

Place this product on a white marble bathroom shelf with soft morning light and a sprig of eucalyptus beside it. Keep the product exactly as it is: the same shape, colours, label and text.

Now show the same product held in a hand against a soft beige background, for an Instagram post.

Before You Publish: Size, Ghosts & the Rules

Create a square image of a hot air balloon floating over misty mountains at sunrise, with empty sky at the top for text.

Now make the same image as a tall vertical version for an Instagram story.

Show, Don't Describe: Working From a Reference Image

Use this image as a reference for the style, lighting and composition. Create the same kind of ad for my skincare brand ALOE ZEST, made with aloe vera and lemon. Show three products floating together: a moisturiser jar, a face wash tube and a toner bottle. Replace the pineapples and coconuts with fresh aloe vera leaves and lemon slices. Use a palette of fresh green, lemon yellow and white, with the name ALOE ZEST on each product.

Keep everything the same, but add the product names clearly under the brand name: MOISTURISER on the jar, FACE WASH on the tube and TONER on the bottle.